

The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: U.S. Navy photo

America launched new air strikes on **Iran**. America's armed forces said it had struck missile sites in the south of the country and boats laying mines, in what it called an act of self defence, "to protect our troops", despite an "ongoing" ceasefire. Iran said it shot down one American drone that had entered its airspace. Earlier the country's foreign-ministry spokesman said that progress had been made in [peace talks](#), although a deal was "not imminent".

The Israel Defence Forces intensified its attacks on Lebanon after Binyamin Netanyahu ordered an escalation of an offensive against **Hizbullah**. Israel's prime minister said the country would "crush" the [Lebanese militant group](#) despite a ceasefire. The IDF has reportedly crossed the demarcation line Israel drew between 5km and 10km into Lebanese territory after the April ceasefire.

The board of **BP**, a British oil giant, unanimously agreed to oust Albert Manifold, the firm's chairman. It was in response to "serious concerns" about "governance standards, oversight and conduct", according to a company statement. Mr Manifold had been in the role for less than a year, and survived a shareholder revolt last month. BP's shares fell by 8% following the announcement. Ian Tyler will take over in the interim.

Shares of **Ferrari** fell by 6% in early trading on Tuesday after the Italian luxury carmaker launched its [first fully electric vehicle](#). The “Luce”, a sporty five-seater selling for €550,000 (\$640,000), was developed in collaboration with Sir Jony Ive, a former Apple designer. Low demand and fierce Chinese competition has recently seen competitors like Lamborghini and Porsche scale back their EV plans.

North Korea fired missiles and rockets towards the Yellow Sea, according to South Korea’s army. The country’s first launch since mid-April coincided with a rare visit by Singapore’s foreign minister. Xi Jinping, China’s leader, may also visit North Korea in the coming weeks, according to South Korean media.

Mexico agreed to act as the base for **Iran’s football team** during the World Cup, which begins next month. The tournament is being [jointly hosted](#) by America, Canada and Mexico. However Mexico’s president, Claudia Sheinbaum, said that America “did not want the Iranian team to stay overnight”. Iran’s first three games are scheduled to be played in America.

Sonny Rollins, a tenor saxophonist and composer of numerous jazz standards including “Oleo” and “Airegin”, died, aged 95. Mr Rollins cut his teeth (and his gums) as a sideman to luminaries including Thelonious Monk and Miles Davis before releasing dozens of records as a band leader. A noted improviser, the “Saxophone Colossus” pioneered techniques and compositional ideas that soon became *de rigueur* in the genre.

Figure of the day: 74. The age of Jean-Luc Mélenchon. [Read about](#) the new political crush of France’s Gen Zs.



Photograph: Shutterstock

The Quad meets in Delhi

On Tuesday the foreign ministers of America, India, Japan and Australia gathered in India's capital to revisit a difficult question: how to counter China's growing influence in the Indo-Pacific? For the last decade, the [four members of the Quad](#) have come up with various answers. These have included building interoperable naval and communications systems, improving disaster-relief preparedness, and breaking China's stranglehold on critical minerals and emerging technologies.

But the Quad now faces another challenge: how to draw Donald Trump's attention. America's president revived the Indo-Pacific security outfit in his first term. But these days, he seems more interested in chasing Chinese business deals than checking China's military rise. The ministers will need to make a better case for their coalition. In the best-case scenario, America's Indo-Pacific allies will hope to lure Mr Trump to Delhi for a leader-level summit of the Quad by the end of this year.



Photograph: Getty Images

America's red star votes

Republicans in Texas will vote on Tuesday in a long-awaited [primary runoff](#) to choose their Senate candidate for November. The election caps one of the nastiest and most expensive intraparty fights in state history. John Cornyn, the incumbent, has spent the better part of a year desperately defending his seat against Ken Paxton (pictured), the insurgent attorney-general who clinched Donald Trump's endorsement just last week.

The stakes reach far beyond Texas. There are familiar themes underlying the runoff—a test of the president's hold on the party and of the base's willingness to jettison experienced lawmakers for MAGA warriors. But many Republicans fear that Mr Paxton's legal troubles—for which his own party unsuccessfully impeached him—make him a weaker candidate to challenge [James Talarico](#), the Democratic nominee, who has become a prolific fundraiser. In a close election year, control of the Senate could hinge on America's biggest red state.

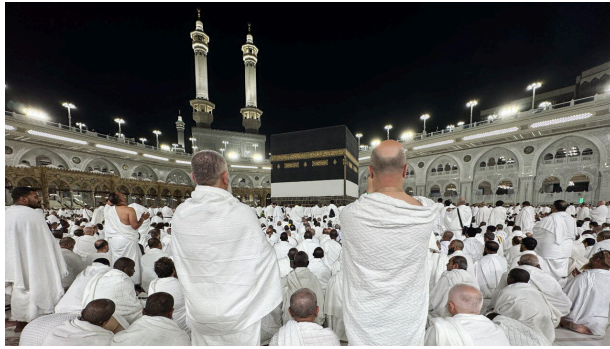


Photograph: Reuters

Is Senegal headed for another political crisis?

As the resignations roll in, Senegal's political crisis is deepening. On Sunday the speaker of parliament resigned—just two days after the firebrand prime minister was fired. (A new premier, technocrat Ahmadou Al Amine Lo, was announced late on Monday). On Tuesday that ejected firebrand, Ousmane Sonko (pictured), may emerged as the new speaker, winning 132 out of 133 votes. That will enable him to keep wielding his party's large parliamentary majority to influence politics. At a party conference on June 6th and local elections in November, he will probably cement his grip even further.

The rupture follows months of tensions and disagreements on tackling the country's [ballooning debt](#). The IMF halted Senegal's programme in 2024, in response to miscalculated debt figures under the previous administration, and the economy has stalled since. In April the fund cut Senegal's GDP-growth forecast to 2.2%. While Mr Sonko rejected IMF proposals as offensive to Senegal's dignity, his departure could finally enable a more pragmatic Mr Faye to push on.



Photograph: Getty Images

Muslims make peace with a pricey hajj

In recent months the Gulf has become a risky travel destination as Iran has showered it with missiles and drones. Disruptions have also made travel to the region more expensive. Yet this week around 1.7m Muslims (slightly more than last year) are nonetheless expected to take part in the *hajj*, the annual Islamic pilgrimage to Mecca in Saudi Arabia this week.

Demand for the *hajj* remains high because it is one of the five “pillars” of Islam. The Koran instructs all Muslims to complete it once if they are financially and physically able. Some countries, such as Malaysia and Indonesia, always easily use up an annual quota of visas granted by Saudi Arabia, the host. Around 5.7m Indonesians are on a waiting-list. Some wait 40 years to be selected. If they are still alive when their turn comes, they are unlikely to decline it.



Photograph: Getty Images

The day of the jackal

In the Middle Ages the grey wolf ruled Europe, gobbling up sheep (and people). Wolves kept other canids at bay—the golden jackal, for example, was confined to slivers of coast in southeastern Europe. But over time humans, like Charlemagne’s *luparii*, learned to repel this lupine apex predator.

Europe’s [wild canids](#) are in flux again. A new study published this week in *Nature Ecology & Evolution* predicts that jackals will soon occupy three-quarters of the continent—six times their current range. Researchers played recordings of jackals howling at 8,991 locations across Europe between 2001 and 2017 to measure where the animals were (nearby jackals howled back). Even though wolves (the strongest constraint on jackals) are recovering, the study found that they may only reduce jackals’ range by 18%. That is because jackals’ proximity to humans now protects them from wolves (which avoid people). The jackal’s rise shows how humans change relationships between animals. This will change ecosystems: these small predators scavenge carcasses, control rodents and, like wolves, eat livestock.



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Tuesday: Which architect designed the Guggenheim museum in New York?

Monday: Which Republican Senator from Virginia was married to Elizabeth Taylor?

*If my heart isn't in my mouth it's
because it knows its place.*

Phyllis Gotlieb